

Why Tier 3 Cities Are Now A Cheat Code

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Executive Summary

Tier 3 cities — Budva, Budapest, Vlorë, Zagreb, Belgrade, Panama and others — now deliver a better lifestyle than Tier 1 cities: lower taxes, cheap property, safer streets, better culture, and real financial freedom for location-independent earners.

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The Henry Girard / Bond Villain Awakening 0:00

- Chris frames the whole video around a character from the film *War Dogs* — Henry Girard, played by Bradley Cooper
 - He previously modelled himself on James Bond (Casino Royale at age 14), but at 24, after returning from 2 years in Toronto, he watched War Dogs and had a shift
 - The key scene: in a Las Vegas casino, Jonah Hill's character says "Vegas is a two-day town," Bradley Cooper leans in and whispers, **"I was talking about America."**
 - That line hit differently after years of world travel — he finally understood it viscerally
- The distinction he draws between Bond and Girard:
 - Bond = suits, glitz, glamour, the Caribbean
 - Girard = frontier places, Albania, Montenegro — "the dirty, dingy side of James Bond"
 - "It was never about the suits. It was more about going to the frontier places of the world."
- At 24 he decided: *"I didn't want to be James Bond anymore. I wanted to be a Bond villain."*
- The Bond villain archetype:
 - Never lives in an LA mansion
 - Has safe houses pocketed around the world — not expensive, just small flats with a nice view

- Drives a blacked-out Range Rover low-key through Budapest, not a loud Lamborghini
- Speaks multiple languages, stays anonymous, doesn't flaunt wealth publicly
- The Tates are used as a real-world case study (despite Chris explicitly saying he dislikes them):
 - Their early Bucharest years — shitty indoor pool, converted warehouse gym, one supercar, coffee shop interviews in the snow — were the most magnetic, authentic version of this lifestyle
 - "That rawness is what captured everybody."
 - Moving to Miami and Dubai, going on massive podcasts, flexing billionaire status — that destroyed it
 - **"They self-snitched on themselves, Tate style."** The Bond villain stays low-key.

The Propaganda Problem: We Were Lied To About the World 1:37

- Core claim: wherever you grow up, you're hit with propaganda that your country is the centre of the universe and the best place on Earth
 - USA, UK, Australia, Canada — all citizens receive this framing
 - "History is written by the winners" — the dominant narrative benefits those in power
- The "Made in China" example:
 - Movies and pop culture constantly mock Chinese products as cheap junk
 - Chris's experience: everything he's ordered from China has been exceptional
 - Pool heater example: bought from China for **£1,800**; the identical unit cost **£9,000 in Spain** — the Spanish retailer literally just put a sticker on it
- Places he expected to be bad that blew him away:
 - **Bali**: gyms are world-class; furniture is the best he's ever seen anywhere ("Nothing comes close"); food is very good
 - **Marrakech / Morocco**: visited with ONEM group, stayed in Hivernage area — Ferraris, Nobu rooftop, sky-blue pools, designer clothes everywhere. His Moroccan girlfriend's friends from school all own 2–3 houses. "We used to send money to you." She laughed: "We've always had money."
 - **Montenegro**: one unrepaired road vs. modern casino hotels, Bay of Kotor restaurants and cafes — "This might actually be better than the UK."
 - **Budapest**: clubs, rooftop bars, expensive restaurants, guys in G-Wagons and 110 Defenders — the exact lifestyle everyone says they want, available at a fraction of Western cost
 - **Belgrade**: four ONEM members stopped there en route to Montenegro — "brilliant, women are beautiful, food great, felt super safe"
 - **Poland**: one member just returned, considering buying an apartment
 - **Lithuania**: ONEM members say it's incredible, better than Granada
 - **Albania (Vlorë, Ksamil, Sarandë)**: massive hotels under construction; Ivanka Trump and Jared Kushner working with Aman Resorts on a major resort in Vlorë; new airport just built. Albanian woman at the airport told him: "The gangs in the UK are people who got kicked out — it's one of the safest places you'll ever go."
 - **Zagreb**: described as possibly the best-located city in the world (see Tier 3 section)

- The UK reality check (stats cited in embedded clip):
 - Citizens outside London and the Southeast have **less disposable income than the poorest 5 US states** and the average OECD country
 - Remove London and the Southeast → UK GDP per capita drops **14%**
 - Life expectancy in parts of **Blackpool** is lower than in **Rwanda**
 - "The UK minus London and the Cotswolds is third world."
- US reality check:
 - Chris publicly states he thinks America is a third world country outside of Miami and New York
 - Philadelphia, Detroit, San Francisco (declining) cited as examples
 - "People are worse off than they would be living in Montenegro or Albania."



What Happened to Tier 1 Cities? [1:42](#)

- Tier 1 cities (New York, London, Tokyo) used to offer:
 - All the opportunities and biggest money
 - The most beautiful women ("Sweden doesn't have the most beautiful Swedish women — they live in New York and London")
 - Best cafes, restaurants, culture
- What's changed — five compounding problems:
 - **Sky-high taxes**: making more but keeping less
 - **Rents and house prices**: making £80–100k/year is meaningless when a coffee costs £6–9 and rent is £2,800–5,600/month
 - **Crime explosion**: Chris was paying £2,800/month in Canary Wharf; 300 (rising to 500) criminals were moved into the hotel opposite — riots, one woman nearly raped, theft, disorder, nothing done about it. That's why he left.
 - **Cultural decay**: the beautiful, ambitious people who made Tier 1 cities great are leaving because they can't afford it — flat-sharing with 6 people, moving to Manchester or city outskirts
 - "Old immigration gave us culture. New immigration just gives us criminals."
 - **The social environment**: London dating — "a 30-year-old woman shouting at you for liking younger women" vs. a 21-year-old in Montenegro saying "I want to settle down, I think the man should be older, successful, take care of me"
- London cost comparisons:
 - Coffee: **£5–9** (Americans visiting call it the most expensive city they've ever been)
 - Canary Wharf flat: **£2,800/month** — no terrace, no pool, no rooftop
 - Battersea nice flat: **£5,600/month**
 - What £5,600/month gets you in Montenegro: giant villa in Becici Bay overlooking the sea, with a boat, jet ski, car, and **~£2,000/month to spare**

Why Tier 2 Cities Lost Their Edge 1:37

- Tier 2 cities used to be the smart alternative — now they have Tier 1 pricing with worse quality
 - Cost of living, taxes, and rents have caught up with Tier 1 cities
 - "Tier twos have got Tier 1 pricing. The quality is worse than Tier 1. So what's the point?"
- This is what forces the drop to Tier 3

Why Tier 3 Cities Are the Winning Strategy 1:19

- Core thesis: **Tier 3 cities now offer the advantages Tier 1 cities used to offer, without the downsides**
- What defines a Tier 3 city (his framework):
 - Affordable house prices
 - Low or flat taxes (Budapest: **10% flat rate**; Panama: very low)
 - Coffee for **€1–2**
 - Enough infrastructure to live well (gyms, restaurants, modern hotels, fiber internet built from scratch = faster than legacy Western infrastructure)
 - Women who haven't been through "20 years of feminist educational programming"
 - Less regulation and bureaucracy (Montenegro leasing laws: "They haven't been written yet — they write custom laws based on your use case")
 - Community spirit, safety, hospitality — people return lost £400 Prada sunglasses; Bali GrabBike drivers gave free rides and Wi-Fi cable, refused payment
 - A place "on the come-up" — you watch it develop, shopping improves, buildings go up
- Specific Tier 3 cities named:
 - **Budva, Montenegro** — beachside, casino, modern hotels, Bay of Kotor nearby
 - **Budapest, Hungary** — 10% flat tax, cheap property (see examples), great gyms, beautiful women, rooftop bars
 - **Vlorë, Albania** — currently teetering Tier 3/4, "good time to get in"; Aman Resort development; new airport
 - **Ksamil & Sarandë, Albania** — on the Dalmatian coast near Greece, stunning bay
 - **Belgrade, Serbia** — members raved about it
 - **Zagreb, Croatia** — possibly the best-located city in the world:
 - Within driving distance of Budapest, Rome, Milan, Turin, Dolomites, Switzerland (Zurich, Lausanne), Dalmatian coast (Hvar, Split), Montenegro, Albania
 - ONEM member there says: beautiful women, great gyms, great food, "even in winter it's 18°C and sunny"
 - **Panama & Paraguay** — cheap beach houses (see property section)
 - **Buenos Aires** — "like a European city in South America"; members looking at properties
 - **Lithuania** — ONEM members say it's incredible
 - **Poland** — members considering buying apartments

- Historical context — why this shift is happening:
 - Civilizations always rotate: Greeks, Romans, Mongols, Persian Empire — "Everything flips on its head every 16,000 years or so"
 - Tier 3 cities are in a **renaissance period** — being built from scratch means modern materials, high-speed internet from day one, air conditioning standard
 - Africa cited as the next wave: "Everything being built from scratch — iPhones, high-speed internet, modern materials. They've just skipped 20,000 years of mistakes."
 - Jakarta now has more millionaires than most parts of the world
- The "Born on a Budget" / safe house strategy:
 - Instead of one big mortgage ("an ankle bracelet") in a high-tax country:
 - Small apartment in Vlorë (~beach, Albania)
 - Small flat in Budva
 - Little house in Belgrade
 - Place in Zagreb (ski Dolomites, pop to Milan, Portofino)
 - Multiple safe houses = freedom, no single financial trap
 - Rent one out on Airbnb when living in another
- Nomad Capitalist cited: "Go where you're treated best" — Chris doubles it: "Go where you can **maximize your life.**"
- Reference to **Aman Resorts founder (Adrian Zecha)**: started in Southeast Asia because he couldn't have done it in Miami/NY/LA — smaller places with less money = bigger opportunity
- Abu Dhabi / Sharjah lesson:
 - Years ago Chris told his audience to move to Sharjah (20 min from Dubai) — dirt cheap, amazing value — didn't act on it, now house prices are "through the roof"
 - Same opportunity now exists in Abu Dhabi: boring but complete, drive to Dubai for fun

Real Property Examples: Budapest & Panama 2:30

- Chris does a live, unscripted property browse on screen during the video

Budapest properties: | Property | Price | Notes | |---|---|---| | Studio in Royal View Resort & Spa | **€249,000** | New development, full resort facilities (spa, pool, gym) | | Small flat near city center | **£150,000** | 1,200m walk to city, balcony, liveable as-is | | Penthouse (needs work) | Listed but browsed | Elevator access, potential is enormous | | First ONEM trip house (rented) | **£3,100/week** to rent | Budapest landlord: inherited house for **€80K**, now owns **4 properties**, lives by the river with wife and kids |

- Budapest landlord anecdote (key illustration):
 - 35-year-old Hungarian man, inherited €80K from his father
 - Bought the first ONEM trip house outright for that amount
 - Now owns 4 houses total; rents them to visiting groups
 - Lives a calm modern life by the river: "I wake up, grab a coffee, grab food, see my parents."

- "We all got told you were third world and you were broken." He laughed.
- Two Budapest houses combined total: ~**£400,000** — both paid off, rent one out, live in the other, or travel between both
- Recommended agent: **Leo Hunt** — "Super professional, huge amount of knowledge. Spoke to them for hours."
- Hungary tax/banking notes:
 - **10% flat income tax**
 - Bank accounts described as "effortless to set up"
 - Property tax tip exists (not shared on video — saved for paid course)

Panama properties: | Property | Price | Notes | |---|---|---| | Giant beach house, multiple bedrooms, pool | **\$704,000** | Needs modernizing; equivalent Miami house = ~\$12M | | Small unit (likely crypto buyer type) | **\$96,000** | Low bills, low taxes; probably used 2 weeks/year as investment | | Ocean-view 2-bed apartment with pool/jacuzzi | Bid ~**\$280,000** | Skyscrapers + ocean view, infinity pool, indoor jacuzzi, sun loungers, gym, 24/7 concierge, doorman, valet, sauna, yoga studio, EV charging — Chris actually messaged the agent (Carlos) live on stream and is "deadly serious" about bidding |

- Chris's comparison: the Panama 2-bed looks identical to his old **£2,800/month** Canary Wharf flat — same floor, same design, same view — but he could own this for ~\$280K
- Key amenity point: "I'd spend 2K on gym equipment for the building just because I'm saving so much money. They'd be like 'why?' I'd say 'donation.'"
- Wi-Fi in Tier 3: built from scratch = fiber from day one, exceptionally fast

The Mindset Shift: Low-Key, High Quality 3:27

- The local happiness insight — people in Tier 3 areas need less because their lifestyle baseline is already high:
 - Spain: drive to beach, make a picnic (cheap food, cheap fuel), swim, talk, come home — house bought and paid for
 - Morocco: girlfriend's friends put foldable chairs anywhere with a view, have a drink and food, "time of their life"
 - Montenegro: three Kosovan brothers with a window-installing company, nice Mercedes, driving place to place — "We don't need a lot. We've got an amazing life."
 - Inheritance: in Spain/Morocco, parents die → you inherit a paid-off house → buy another cash. In UK/US → inheritance gets taxed → what remains doesn't cover a deposit
- Tommy Shelby quote invoked: "I have three gardeners, three generations of men with no ambition, and they were happier than I will ever be."
- The supercar / big house illusion:
 - You don't need a supercar — you can get from A to B in a cheap car. Nobody in Spain cares what you drive.
 - You don't need a giant house — "you're going to watch TV and sleep, you can do that in a small house"

- Any woman who requires you to have a £2M Miami house is "not the woman for you"
- ONEM member Adrian rented an expensive car for a month, gave it back: "Pointless. Just gives you a bill."
- Chris drove Skodas while dating his girlfriend — "they're reliable, get you from A to B"
- **The Tate lesson re-stated:** their dream lifestyle was the quiet early Bucharest years. Getting loud, going to Miami, chasing fame — that was the mistake. "Stay low-key. Have a nice life. Nobody needs to know who you are."
- Community spirit in non-Western places:
 - Spain: left £400 Prada sunglasses on a seat → stranger immediately returned them. Camera guy left camera on London floor for 3 minutes → gone.
 - Bali: hotel was closed, stranger gave phone cable + Wi-Fi + cried over the situation, two GrabBike riders drove him for free to the best hotel (Kaia — recommended if visiting Bali), gave their number for follow-up
- Course mentions:
 - Free Tier 3 video available in **ONEM free School community** (Day 1 content)
 - Tier 3 criteria breakdown + property tax tricks + Estonia company setup + American LLC info in **ONEM paid course ("Own The Man Work")** — **£450/year**, 250 course videos; "the course is free, you're paying for the network"

What to Do Next 3:51

- Single most important action: **travel and see it with your own eyes**
 - "You will not know until you go and see it. You'll think 'what was Chris talking about?' Until you actually see it."
- His first Budapest arrival alone at night:
 - Expected to be scammed by taxi driver — wasn't
 - Asked a coffee shop for Wi-Fi and phone charge — woman helped immediately, someone walked him to his destination
 - "Nobody knows who you are. 10pm, walking around, feeling safe. The possibilities here are crazy. A whole new level of the map has just been unlocked."
- Decision framework for those held back by family/relationships:
 - Citing Nomad Capitalist: sit down with family, girlfriend, wife — ask if they want to do this
 - If they say no and won't budge: "Maybe I'm going to leave this person. Maybe I'm going to move on."
 - "If she won't live this lifestyle and just travel around... get rid of her."
- The vision — the Henry Girard / Bond villain life setup:
 - Blacked-out Range Rover, Budapest
 - Drive to Zagreb
 - Drop down to Budva

- Cross to Vlorë
- Beach house in Ksamil
- Fly to Crete, little place in Paros
- Local restaurant, best coffee, best meat, work on laptop
- **"Nobody knows you're rich. That's the point."**

"It's not until you travel, not until you get out to these other parts of the world, that your mind expands. A whole new level of the map has just been unlocked."